

Sphamandla Lawrence Tshabalala

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Subject: Application for Cloud Security Analyst Role

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to express my strong enthusiasm for joining your organization, especially given my long-standing interest in your work on **secure cloud infrastructure** and **digital transformation**. I am convinced that my foundational expertise in core security principles, validated by recent certifications, aligns perfectly with the technical requirements of a proactive security team.

My transition into cybersecurity is supported by a robust set of credentials secured in 2025, demonstrating my commitment to operational and offensive security practices:

- **CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701):** Validates my baseline knowledge of security controls, threat management, risk mitigation, and implementing essential security protocols.
- **Cisco Networking Academy's Ethical Hacker Course:** Provides hands-on, practical skills in **vulnerability scanning, penetration testing methodologies**, post-exploitation activities, and professional security reporting.
- **Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900):** Establishes a solid understanding of fundamental security, compliance, and identity concepts within the Microsoft cloud ecosystem.

Combined with my **NCV Level 4 in Information Technology**, which covered foundational principles like Computer Programming, Data Communications, and Networking, I offer a well-rounded skill set that bridges IT infrastructure with modern security operations.

My previous experience as a Store Associate at Mr Price Sport refined critical soft skills—including **leadership, proactive problem-solving, and clear communication**—which I recognize are vital for translating technical risks into clear business requirements and collaborating effectively across teams.

I am eager to apply my practical skills, particularly in **vulnerability analysis and defensive security operations**, to help safeguard your digital assets. I am highly ready to tackle complex challenges and grow within a professional environment.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how I can immediately contribute to your team's success in maintaining a secure cloud environment.

Sincerely,

Sphamandla Lawrence Tshabalala